

Module 8: Management Team Questions:

Questions	Answers
Briefly describe the background and skill sets of each team member and why those skills are critical to the company's success in the next 18 months.	Our founding team combines deep expertise in energy, policy, and AI. Courtney brings over a decade of experience in energy systems, utility regulation, and clean technology, including leadership roles at RMI and COP28. This strategic background is critical to navigating the regulatory and market complexities of deploying our Intelligent Energy Hub (IEH). Kiptoo is an electrical engineer with expertise in embedded systems, AI/ML integration, and hardware prototyping, ensuring our core product moves from concept to MVP. Abhishek has extensive experience in partnerships and business model design us to secure pilot sites and early adopters.
What skills are missing from your current team to achieve your 18-month milestones successfully?	We lack a dedicated full-stack software engineer to accelerate development of the IEH interface and backend analytics. Additionally, we require a product operations specialist to oversee pilot deployments and manage customer feedback loops. While we have strong market strategy, we need additional expertise in industrial design for manufacturability to reduce cost and ensure scalability.
How will you fill those gaps? (e.g. advisors, consultants, new employees?)	We plan to recruit a contract full-stack engineer within the next 3 months, transitioning to a full-time hire post-prototype validation. For product operations and pilot execution, we will leverage consultants with commercial real estate and building systems experience while recruiting a dedicated operations lead. We are engaging design-for-manufacture consultants and exploring partnerships with Michigan-based hardware manufacturers.
Does each member of your team have an updated resume / LinkedIn profile they could send or hand out when requested?	Yes, all current team members maintain updated resumes and LinkedIn profiles, which are readily available for investors, partners, and program requirements.

What processes or activities do you have, or plan to implement, in your company to improve the effectiveness of your team? (e.g. how do you assign tasks, know that things get done, keep everyone updated, etc?)	We use a weekly sprint planning and review process with clear deliverables, tracked through Slack. Daily check-ins are conducted for technical progress, while bi-weekly strategic reviews align market, product, and fundraising efforts. Regular pilot-readiness meetings ensure that hardware, software, and partner outreach remain synchronized.
What plans or activities do you have to encourage diversity of your team?	We actively seek diverse candidates in recruitment, prioritizing inclusion across gender, ethnicity, and professional background. We plan to partner with local universities and accelerator programs to identify emerging talent from underrepresented groups in energy and technology.